

# DRACULA

*The most powerful vampire on Earth*

DRACULA

## FACTFILE

### REAL NAME

Vlad Tepes Dracula

### OCCUPATION

Ruler of Earth's vampires

### BASE

Castle Dracula, Transylvania;  
otherwise mobile

**HEIGHT** 6 ft 5 in

**WEIGHT** 220 lbs

**EYES** Red

**HAIR** Black

### FIRST APPEARANCE

Tomb of Dracula #1 (April 1972)

POWERS

Drains blood from victims by biting, enabling him to control their wills. Those who die become vampires. Has superhuman strength, virtual immortality, and cannot be killed by conventional means. Transforms into a bat, wolf, or mist. Can mentally control other vampires and mesmerize human beings.



Vlad Tepes Dracula was born in 1430 in Schassberg, Transylvania. The following year his father, the Transylvanian nobleman Vlad Dracul, became prince of nearby Wallachia. Dracula's father was later assassinated by other Transylvanians. Dracula nevertheless went through with the marriage his father had arranged with Zofia, a Hungarian noblewoman. After the birth of their daughter, Dracula put an end to their marriage. Zofia committed suicide; her daughter would become the vampiress LILITH.

## THE IMPALER

Dracula regained the throne of Wallachia in 1456, and had those responsible for his father's assassination impaled. He then fought a war with the Turks, during which he impaled huge numbers of them. Hence Dracula became known as "Vlad the Impaler." Dracula married his second wife, Maria, who bore him a son, Vlad Tepelus.

In 1459, Dracula was defeated in battle by the Turkish warlord Turac, who mortally wounded him. Turac took Dracula to the gypsy healer Lianda, who proved to be a vampiress and bit and killed Dracula, transforming him into a vampire. After Turac murdered Maria, Dracula slew him and turned his son Vlad Tepelus over to the care of

gypsies. By defeating the vampire Nimrod, Dracula took his place as the ruler of Earth's vampires. The eldest vampire on Earth, Varnae, enhanced Dracula's blood with his own before killing himself. As a result Dracula became the most powerful vampire on the planet.



Dracula's most persistent modern adversaries were (from left to right) the team of Quincy Harker, Frank Drake, Rachel Van Helsing, and Blade.

## THE VAMPIRE HUNTERS

In 1890 Dracula employed British solicitor Jonathan Harker to buy Carfax Abbey in England. Moving there, Dracula attacked Harker's fiancée Mina Murray. Vampire hunter Abraham Van Helsing intervened and led the pursuit of Dracula to Transylvania, where Van Helsing's allies impaled the vampire. However, Dracula has repeatedly returned from real or apparent death, and he has continued to menace humanity into the 21st century.

In recent years, Dracula's nemeses were a team led by Jonathan Harker's son, Quincy. Among his allies were Rachel Van Helsing, Abraham's descendant; Dracula's own descendant FRANK DRAKE; and the vampire hunter BLADE. Quincy Harker and Rachel Van Helsing have died, but Drake and Blade continue the hunt. Dracula has also battled such adversaries as DOCTOR STRANGE, the vampire detective Hannibal KING, and the monster hunter Elsa BLOODSTONE. **PS**

## ESSENTIAL STORYLINES

- **Dracula Lives #2-3** How Count Dracula first became a vampire
- **Tomb of Dracula #45-59** Dracula married Domini and fathers Janus, who rapidly becomes an adult who opposes him.
- **Tomb of Dracula #64-70** Dracula becomes human again. After regaining his powers, Dracula and Quincy Harker die in their final confrontation.

